SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

16 October 2024 · Shift 2

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 12 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.3

The average weight of 12 students and two teachers is 55 kg. When one teacher weighing 68 kg is included in the group, then the average weight of the group (in kg) is:

(A) 54.5
(B) 56.5
(C) 56
(D) 55

Q.4

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹940 for 3 years at 5% per annum.

(A) ₹140
(B) ₹142
(C) ₹141
(D) ₹143

Q.5

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 5% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 350
(B) 390
(C) 310
(D) 290

Q.6

In a group of 260 people, one-fourth are women, two-fifth are men and the rest are children. The average age of women is five-sixth of the average age of men, average age of children is one-third of the average age of men. If the average age of men is 48 years, what is the average age of the group in years?

(A) 34.8
(B) 32.7
(C) 38.4
(D) 42.7

Q.8

A man bought an article for ₹500 and sold it for ₹600. Find his profit percentage.

(A) 20%
(B) 40%
(C) 30%
(D) 10%

Q.9

Aniruddh invested ₹15,000 in the shares of a company. The shares rose by 15% one day and fell by 10% on the other day. What is the current value (in ₹) of Aniruddh's investment?

(A) 15450
(B) 15750
(C) 15525
(D) 15500

Q.10

Find the ratio of the curved surface areas of two cones if the diameters of the bases are equal and slant heights are in the ratio 5 : 3.

(A) 7 : 5
(B) 3 : 2
(C) 5 : 3
(D) 2 : 3

Q.11

The difference between discounts on a bill for ₹22,500 under two schemes, a discount of 40% and two successive discounts of 36% and 4%, is:

(A) ₹356
(B) ₹342
(C) ₹324
(D) ₹365

Q.12

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 6% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 780
(B) 840
(C) 800
(D) 880

Q.13

Two classes took the same test. One class of 20 students made an average grade of 85%, the other class of 30 students made an average grade of 70%. The average grade for all students across both classes is:

(A) 76%
(B) 75%
(C) 74%
(D) 72%

Q.14

A and B are running in the same direction at the speeds of 9km/h and 3km/h, respectively, on a circular track of length 27 km. They will meet again after:

(A) 4 hours
(B) 3.5 hours
(C) 4.5 hours
(D) 3 hours

Q.15

In the what ratio must a shopkeeper mix 2 types of rice worth ₹80/kg and ₹100/kg, so that the average cost of the mixture is ₹95/kg?

(A) 1 : 4
(B) 1 : 2
(C) 1 : 3
(D) 2 : 3

Q.18

If the cost price of 30 books is same as the selling price of 20 books, then the gain percentage is:

(A) 25%
(B) 50%
(C) 15%
(D) 40%

Q.20

If 12 : x :: x : 27 and 25 : y :: y : 36, where x and y are both positive numbers, then find x : y.

(A) 5 : 6
(B) 7 : 9
(C) 3 : 5
(D) 4 : 7

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 14 questions

Q.1

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the following series based on the English alphabetical order? PAX, RCV, TET, VGR, ?

(A) XIP
(B) XJP
(C) XIQ
(D) XJQ

Q.2

This question has two statements followed by two conclusions numbered I and II. You have to take the given statements to be true even if they seem to be at variance from commonly known facts. You have to decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the given statements. Statements: All bags are purses. No purse is a wallet. Conclusions (I) At least some wallets are purses. (II) No bag is a wallet.

(A) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(B) Only conclusion (II) follows
(C) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(D) Only conclusion (I) follows

Q.4

In a certain code language, 'MONK' is coded as '1238' and 'HONK' is coded as '8326'. What is the code for 'H' in that language?

(A) 6
(B) 8
(C) 2
(D) 3

Q.5

RZ31 is related to TB25 in a certain way. In the same way, JR46 is related to LT40. To which of the following is GO18 related following the same logic?

(A) IQ12
(B) JP12
(C) JP15
(D) IQ15

Q.7

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '÷' and '+' are interchanged and '–' and '×' are interchanged? 17 ÷ 27 × 7 – 9 + 3 = ?

(A) 76
(B) 34
(C) 23
(D) 122

Q.9

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: All chocolates are juices. No juice is a biscuit. Conclusions: (I) No chocolate is a biscuit. (II) No biscuit is a juice.

(A) Only conclusion I follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Only conclusion II follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.10

In a certain code language, 'FOUR' is coded as '3157' and 'RENT' is coded as '2384'. What is the code for 'R' in the given code language?

(A) 3
(B) 7
(C) 4
(D) 2

Q.11

A, B, C, D, E and F are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). A is sitting third to the left of B. C is sitting second to the right of F. A is sitting to the immediate left of C. D is not an immediate neighbour of C. What is the position of B with respect to E?

(A) Immediate left
(B) Immediate right
(C) Second to the right
(D) Second to the left

Q.12

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '÷' are interchanged and '–' and '×' are interchanged? 4 – 6 × 27 ÷ 72 + 6 = ?

(A) 6
(B) 14
(C) 1
(D) 9

Q.13

43 is related to 87 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 63 is related to 127. To which of the following is 52 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 111
(B) 101
(C) 105
(D) 108

Q.14

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g., 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (8, 320, 4) (1, 70, 7)

(A) (2, 110, 5)
(B) (3, 22, 5)
(C) (3, 10, 7)
(D) (2, 40, 2)

Q.18

In a certain code language, 'she is intelligent' is written as 'le me re' and 'she is studious' is written as 're de me'. How is 'studious' written in the given code language?

(A) me
(B) re
(C) le
(D) de

Q.19

Seven people P, Q, R, S, T, U and V are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). S is sitting third to the left of V. T is sitting second to the right of S. P is sitting fourth to the right of Q. U is sitting second to the left of P. What is the position of R with respect to T?

(A) Third to the right
(B) Second to the left
(C) To the immediate left
(D) Third to the left

Q.20

What should come in place of '?' in the given series? 5040, 6064, 6576, 6832, 6960, ?

(A) 7088
(B) 7024
(C) 7472
(D) 7216

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

The property of rock or soil that indicates the ability of allowing fluids to flow through it is called:

(A) Plasticity
(B) Stability
(C) Permeability
(D) Density

Q.2
Which of the following Articles of the Constitution mentions that, “There shall be paid to the Judges of the Supreme Court, such salaries as may be determined by the Parliament by law, and until provision in that behalf is so made, such salaries as are specified in the Second Schedule”?

(A) 124
(B) 126
(C) 125
(D) 127

Q.3
Identify the INCORRECT pair.

(A) Blossom Shower - Andhra Pradesh
(B) Nor Westers - West Bengal
(C) Bardoisila - Assam
(D) Mango Shower - Kerala

Q.4
In which state is the Jhumming cultivation known as Dahiya?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Odisha
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.5
Who among the following became the first Indian to win a gold medal at the World Athletics Championships event?

(A) Neeraj Chopra
(B) Murli Shree Sankar
(C) Milkha Singh
(D) Duti Chand

Q.6
Which food is a good source of complete protein?

(A) Lentils
(B) Rice
(C) Spinach
(D) Eggs

Q.7
Gulbarga and Bidar style of architecture was patronised by which of the following dynasties?

(A) Maratha dynasty
(B) Nanda dynasty
(C) Tuluva dynasty
(D) Bahmani dynasty

Q.8
Captain Hawkins visited India during the reign of:

(A) Shahjahan
(B) Babur
(C) Akbar
(D) Jahangir

Q.9
Who is the writer of the novel ‘A Suitable Boy’?

(A) Mahesh Rao
(B) Vikram Seth
(C) Arvind Adiga
(D) Neel Mukherjee

Q.10
The first ICC Women's T20 Cricket World Cup was hosted by _____.

(A) South Africa
(B) Australia
(C) England
(D) India

Q.11
Darshana Jhaveri, a famous Manipuri dancer, was awarded the Padma Shri in which of the following years?

(A) 2001
(B) 2002
(C) 2003
(D) 2005

Q.12
Who was named as the president of Shiv Sena (Shinde Group) during the party's national executive meeting in Mumbai in February 2023?

(A) Eknath Shinde
(B) Aaditya Thackeray
(C) Sanjay Raut
(D) Uddhav Thackeray

Q.13
Kishori Amonkar, one of the finest classical singers of Hindustani music, was from which state?

(A) Bihar
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Gujarat
(D) Maharashtra

Q.14
Which of the following initiatives of the Government of India promises 100 days of guaranteed wage employment to all the rural households who volunteer to do unskilled manual work?

(A) Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme
(B) Pradhan Mantri Rojgar Protsahan Yojana
(C) Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan
(D) National Career Service

Q.15
Who among the following was NOT associated with the ‘Prarthana Sabha’?

(A) Atmaram Pandurang
(B) RG Bhandarkar
(C) Govind Ranade
(D) Mahatma Gandhi

Q.16
The Maukharies ruled over _____ in western Uttar Pradesh, which later on replaced Pataliputra as the political centre of northern India.

(A) Agra
(B) Kanauj
(C) Mathura
(D) Jhansi

Q.17
Which type of molecules show dipole-dipole interaction?

(A) Molecules possessing permanent dipole
(B) Ionic molecules
(C) Non-polar molecules
(D) Molecules possessing transient dipole

Q.18
In September 2023, which Chief Minister of an Indian state won the Lee Kuan Yew Exchange Fellowship for his distinguished contribution to public service?

(A) Yogi Adityanath
(B) Himanta Biswa Sarma
(C) Naveen Patnayak
(D) Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Q.19
Match list I of cell organelles with their functions in list II. List I: (a) Endoplasmic reticulum (b) Vacuoles (c) Golgi apparatus (d) Mitochondria List II: (i) for packaging of materials synthesised near the ER and dispatching them to various targets. (ii) generates ATP. (iii) are storage sacs for solid or liquid contents. (iv) serve as channels for the transport of proteins.

(A) (a) - (iv); (b) - (i); (c) - (iii); (d) - (ii)
(B) (a) - (i); (b) - (iv); (c) - (iii); (d) - (ii)
(C) (a) - (iv); (b) - (iii); (c) - (i); (d) - (ii)
(D) (a) - (iv); (b) - (i); (c) - (ii); (d) - (iii)

Q.20
Mahatma Gandhi Kashi Vidyapith was founded by Shiv Prasad Gupta and Bhagwan Das in the year _____.

(A) 1920
(B) 1919
(C) 1921
(D) 1922

Q.21
From which of the following countries was the concept of the Fundamental Duties borrowed?

(A) Australia
(B) Ireland
(C) Russia
(D) USA

Q.22
For how many days is the Chhat Puja celebrated?

(A) Five
(B) Four
(C) Two
(D) One

Q.23
Air and National Defence are examples of which of the following goods?

(A) Club goods
(B) Private goods
(C) Public goods
(D) Common goods

Q.24
Who among the following personalities said, “What I object to is the ‘craze’ for machinery as such. The craze is for what they call labour-saving machinery. Men go on ‘saving labour’ till thousands are without work and thrown to the open streets to die of starvation.”?

(A) Swami Vivekananda
(B) Mahatma Gandhi
(C) Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Lal Bahadur Shastri

Q.25
'Gaur Maria' dance is performed in which of the following state?

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Gujarat
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Telengana

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. Something that has the quality of being easily broken

(A) Damage
(B) Broken
(C) Brittle
(D) Hard

Q.2
Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. I heard management is planning to transfer me to another department and demote me. I need to confirm if this is true by hearing it “directly from the person involved” and from my manager.

(A) straight from the horse's mouth
(B) on pins and needles
(C) bearing a grudge
(D) in the seventh heaven

Q.3
Select the word that is OPPOSITE in meaning to the underlined word in the given sentence. The name should also be “beneficial” to a strong, long-lasting marketing campaign.

(A) Causal
(B) Advantageous
(C) Detrimental
(D) Desirable

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Although she is “virtuous” in her deeds, people misinterpret her because of her open and bold nature.

(A) moral
(B) wicked
(C) sane
(D) commendable

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Accessible
(B) Separate
(C) Concieve
(D) Convenience

Q.6

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. There has been / an increase of the number / of road / accidents recently.

(A) accidents recently
(B) an increase of the number
(C) There has been
(D) of road

Q.7

Select the option that has used the correct tense.

(A) Yesterday, we was painting the door when a neighbour stopping by to say hello.
(B) Yesterday, we will be painting the door when a neighbour stops by to say hello.
(C) Yesterday, we are painting the door when a neighbour stop by to say hello.
(D) Yesterday, we were painting the door when a neighbour stopped by to say hello.

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I checked the _____ to see if it will rain or not.

(A) wether
(B) wither
(C) weather
(D) whether

Q.9

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. He was constantly / gazing on the / crime scene to / find some clues.

(A) find some clues
(B) He was constantly
(C) gazing on the
(D) crime scene to

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The coaches decided to _____ the regulations more strictly because the candidates were not paying attention during their training sessions.

(A) enjoy
(B) enforce
(C) provide
(D) supply

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I have a _____ for reading and want to become a writer when I grow up.

(A) unity
(B) passion
(C) dream
(D) tallow

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. Solving the riddle given by our teacher is “farther” beyond our capacity.

(A) fair
(B) fare
(C) farthest
(D) far

Q.13
Select the correct idiom to substitute the underlined segment in the following sentence. Sean is notorious for “revealing the secrets” about the company.

(A) Being in bad blood
(B) Biting the bullet
(C) Spilling the beans
(D) Biting the dust

Q.14
Rectify the sentence by selecting the correct spelling of the underlined word from the options. He was startled by the loud “thander” during the storm.

(A) thundar
(B) thunder
(C) thondar
(D) thundre

Q.15
Select the most appropriate option that can replace the underlined segment in the given sentence. No sooner had they left “their home that it started” raining heavily.

(A) there home than it started
(B) their home than it starts
(C) their home that it start
(D) their home than it started

Q.16
Select the option that rectifies the error in the usage of the future tense in the given sentence. Shivani go to school tomorrow for prize distribution.

(A) Shivani will go to school tomorrow for prize distribution.
(B) Shivani has gone to school tomorrow for prize distribution.
(C) Shivani goes to school tomorrow for prize distribution.
(D) Shivani had gone to school tomorrow for prize distribution.

Q.17
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Osmium is “heavy” metal in the periodic table.

(A) heavier
(B) the heaviest
(C) the most heavy
(D) more heavy

Q.18
Select the most appropriate word from the options to fill in the blank. Adithya ordered a juicy _____ cooked to perfection at the highway restaurant.

(A) stink
(B) stake
(C) stoke
(D) steak

Q.19
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Excessive

(A) Inordinate
(B) Moderate
(C) Desirable
(D) Flow

Q.20
Select the option that correctly rectifies the underlined spelling error. The scientist made an “appauling” discovery about the environmental impact of the drug.

(A) appalling
(B) apalling
(C) appawling
(D) appaulling

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was just before noon on June 26, 1975, and my friend and I were out exploring the bustling by-lanes of Delhi's Karol Bagh, unaware that the Emergency had been declared, and that it would change our lives in ways we could have never ___1___. Though Indira Gandhi had herself announced the Emergency in a national broadcast at 8 am, IST, the news took its own time to reach the common people who went about their business as always. However, two hours into our outing, we ___2___ something was wrong. The pavement shops began to thin out as we watched and the bigger outlets too looked ready to ___3___; many of them worked behind half-downed shutters. We were young but fancied ourselves as political animals, which at the time was shorthand for being passionately anti-Congress and anti-Indira. There was no way we were going to head home without knowing what had happened. There was already considerable excitement in our small friends' circle over two ___4___ developments: the June 12, 1975 Allahabad high court ruling unseating Indira for electoral malpractices and the Congress's unexpected defeat in the State election in Gujarat. The Supreme Court had allowed Indira to continue as prime minister but that did not ___5___ our joy; it was a technical reprieve that did not lessen the political blow she had received.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) betrothed
(B) targeted
(C) imagined
(D) undermined

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was just before noon on June 26, 1975, and my friend and I were out exploring the bustling by-lanes of Delhi's Karol Bagh, unaware that the Emergency had been declared, and that it would change our lives in ways we could have never ___1___. Though Indira Gandhi had herself announced the Emergency in a national broadcast at 8 am, IST, the news took its own time to reach the common people who went about their business as always. However, two hours into our outing, we ___2___ something was wrong. The pavement shops began to thin out as we watched and the bigger outlets too looked ready to ___3___; many of them worked behind half-downed shutters. We were young but fancied ourselves as political animals, which at the time was shorthand for being passionately anti-Congress and anti-Indira. There was no way we were going to head home without knowing what had happened. There was already considerable excitement in our small friends' circle over two ___4___ developments: the June 12, 1975 Allahabad high court ruling unseating Indira for electoral malpractices and the Congress's unexpected defeat in the State election in Gujarat. The Supreme Court had allowed Indira to continue as prime minister but that did not ___5___ our joy; it was a technical reprieve that did not lessen the political blow she had received.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) sensed
(B) received
(C) feigned
(D) created

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was just before noon on June 26, 1975, and my friend and I were out exploring the bustling by-lanes of Delhi's Karol Bagh, unaware that the Emergency had been declared, and that it would change our lives in ways we could have never ___1___. Though Indira Gandhi had herself announced the Emergency in a national broadcast at 8 am, IST, the news took its own time to reach the common people who went about their business as always. However, two hours into our outing, we ___2___ something was wrong. The pavement shops began to thin out as we watched and the bigger outlets too looked ready to ___3___; many of them worked behind half-downed shutters. We were young but fancied ourselves as political animals, which at the time was shorthand for being passionately anti-Congress and anti-Indira. There was no way we were going to head home without knowing what had happened. There was already considerable excitement in our small friends' circle over two ___4___ developments: the June 12, 1975 Allahabad high court ruling unseating Indira for electoral malpractices and the Congress's unexpected defeat in the State election in Gujarat. The Supreme Court had allowed Indira to continue as prime minister but that did not ___5___ our joy; it was a technical reprieve that did not lessen the political blow she had received.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) wrap up
(B) open up
(C) pop up
(D) chicken out

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was just before noon on June 26, 1975, and my friend and I were out exploring the bustling by-lanes of Delhi's Karol Bagh, unaware that the Emergency had been declared, and that it would change our lives in ways we could have never ___1___. Though Indira Gandhi had herself announced the Emergency in a national broadcast at 8 am, IST, the news took its own time to reach the common people who went about their business as always. However, two hours into our outing, we ___2___ something was wrong. The pavement shops began to thin out as we watched and the bigger outlets too looked ready to ___3___; many of them worked behind half-downed shutters. We were young but fancied ourselves as political animals, which at the time was shorthand for being passionately anti-Congress and anti-Indira. There was no way we were going to head home without knowing what had happened. There was already considerable excitement in our small friends' circle over two ___4___ developments: the June 12, 1975 Allahabad high court ruling unseating Indira for electoral malpractices and the Congress's unexpected defeat in the State election in Gujarat. The Supreme Court had allowed Indira to continue as prime minister but that did not ___5___ our joy; it was a technical reprieve that did not lessen the political blow she had received.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) production
(B) landmark
(C) flaws
(D) mistakes

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was just before noon on June 26, 1975, and my friend and I were out exploring the bustling by-lanes of Delhi's Karol Bagh, unaware that the Emergency had been declared, and that it would change our lives in ways we could have never ___1___. Though Indira Gandhi had herself announced the Emergency in a national broadcast at 8 am, IST, the news took its own time to reach the common people who went about their business as always. However, two hours into our outing, we ___2___ something was wrong. The pavement shops began to thin out as we watched and the bigger outlets too looked ready to ___3___; many of them worked behind half-downed shutters. We were young but fancied ourselves as political animals, which at the time was shorthand for being passionately anti-Congress and anti-Indira. There was no way we were going to head home without knowing what had happened. There was already considerable excitement in our small friends' circle over two ___4___ developments: the June 12, 1975 Allahabad high court ruling unseating Indira for electoral malpractices and the Congress's unexpected defeat in the State election in Gujarat. The Supreme Court had allowed Indira to continue as prime minister but that did not ___5___ our joy; it was a technical reprieve that did not lessen the political blow she had received.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) diminished

(B) dampen

(C) adopted

(D) magnified

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**
Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.3 · Answer (C) 56

SSC's key gives 56 kg, the option nearest the answer: the 14 weigh 14 × 55 = 770 kg, so with the 68 kg teacher the 15 average 838/15 ≈ 55.87 kg, or 56 to the nearest kg. (It is exactly 56 if the 55 kg average is of the 12 students alone: (12 × 55 + 68)/13 = 728/13 = 56.)

Q.4 · Answer (C) ₹141

SI = 940 × 5 × 3/100 = ₹141.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 350

SI = 3,500 × 5 × 2/100 = ₹350.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 34.8

There are 65 women, 104 men and 91 children, with average ages 40, 48 and 16. (65 × 40 + 104 × 48 + 91 × 16)/260 = (2,600 + 4,992 + 1,456)/260 = 9,048/260 = 34.8 years.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 20%

Profit = ₹100 on ₹500: 100/500 × 100 = 20%.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 15525

15,000 × 1.15 × 0.90 = ₹15,525.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 5 : 3

Curved surface area = πrl. Equal diameters mean equal radii, so the areas are in the ratio of the slant heights, 5 : 3.

Q.11 · Answer (C) ₹324

40% of ₹22,500 = ₹9,000. Successive 36% and 4% leave 0.64 × 0.96 = 0.6144 of the bill, a discount of 22,500 × 0.3856 = ₹8,676. The difference is ₹324.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 840

SI = 3,500 × 6 × 4/100 = ₹840.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 76%

(20 × 85 + 30 × 70)/50 = (1,700 + 2,100)/50 = 76%.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 4.5 hours

Running the same way, A gains 9 − 3 = 6 km/h on B. They meet again when A has gained one full lap: 27/6 = 4.5 hours.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 1 : 3

By alligation, ₹80 rice : ₹100 rice = (100 − 95) : (95 − 80) = 5 : 15 = 1 : 3.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 50%

The selling price of 20 books is the cost of 30, so on 20 books the gain is the cost of 10: 10/20 × 100 = 50%.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 3 : 5

$x^2 = 12 \times 27 = 324$, so x = 18; $y^2 = 25 \times 36 = 900$, so y = 30. x : y = 18 : 30 = 3 : 5.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (A) XIP

First letters move +2 (P, R, T, V, X), second letters +2 (A, C, E, G, I) and third letters −2 (X, V, T, R, P): XIP.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Only conclusion (II) follows

All bags are purses and no purse is a wallet, so no bag is a wallet (II). I contradicts 'No purse is a wallet'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 6
O, N and K are in both words, as are 2, 3 and 8 in both codes. The letter left in HONK is H and the digit left in its code is 6, so H = 6.

Q.5 · Answer (A) IQ12
Both letters move 2 places forward and the number falls by 6: R → T, Z → B, 31 → 25 and J → L, R → T, 46 → 40. So GO18 → IQ12.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 23
After interchanging the signs: 17 + 27 – 7 × 9 ÷ 3 = 17 + 27 – 21 = 23.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Both conclusions I and II follow.
All chocolates are juices and no juice is a biscuit, so no chocolate is a biscuit (I). 'No juice is a biscuit' also means 'No biscuit is a juice' (II). Both follow.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 3
R is the only letter in both words and 3 the only digit in both codes, so R = 3.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Immediate right
A is opposite B (third to the left at a table of six) and to C's immediate left, and F is second to C's left. D and E take the two seats beside B, and D cannot sit next to C, so going clockwise the order is C, A, F, D, B, E: B is to E's immediate right.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 9
After interchanging the signs: 4 × 6 – 27 + 72 ÷ 6 = 24 – 27 + 12 = 9.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 105
The second number is twice the first plus 1: 2 × 43 + 1 = 87 and 2 × 63 + 1 = 127. Likewise 2 × 52 + 1 = 105.

Q.14 · Answer (D) (2, 40, 2)
The middle number is ten times the product of the other two: 8 × 4 × 10 = 320 and 1 × 7 × 10 = 70. Likewise 2 × 2 × 10 = 40.

Q.18 · Answer (D) de
'she' and 'is' are in both sentences, as are 'me' and 're' in both codes. The word left in the second sentence is 'studious' and the code left is 'de'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Third to the right
Going clockwise (to each person's left) the order is V, T, P, S, U, R, Q: S is third to V's left, T second to S's right, and only this seat for P puts it fourth to Q's right with U second to its left. R is third to T's right.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 7024
The differences halve: 1,024, 512, 256, 128, so the next is 64: 6,960 + 64 = 7,024.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Permeability
Permeability is the ease with which water or other fluids pass through rock or soil.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 125
Article 125 provides for the salaries of the Judges of the Supreme Court: as Parliament fixes by law, and until then as the Second Schedule specifies.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Blossom Shower - Andhra Pradesh
The blossom shower, which makes coffee flowers bloom, falls in Kerala and nearby areas, not Andhra Pradesh. Nor'westers are West Bengal's Kalbaisakhi, Bardoisila is their name in Assam, and mango showers fall in Kerala and coastal Karnataka.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Madhya Pradesh
NCERT lists 'Bewar' or 'Dahiya' as Madhya Pradesh's names for slash-and-burn cultivation, which is called jhumming in the north-east.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Neeraj Chopra
Neeraj Chopra won the men's javelin at the 2023 World Athletics Championships in Budapest, India's first gold at the championships.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Eggs
Egg protein contains all nine essential amino acids in good proportion, so it is a complete protein. Lentils are low in methionine and rice in lysine, and spinach has little protein.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Bahmani dynasty
Gulbarga, and later Bidar, were the capitals of the Bahmani kingdom, whose rulers built the mosques, tombs and forts there.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Jahangir
William Hawkins of the English East India Company reached Jahangir's court in 1609.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Vikram Seth
'A Suitable Boy' (1993) is Vikram Seth's novel.

Q.10 · Answer (C) England
The first ICC Women's World Twenty20 was held in England in 2009, alongside the men's tournament.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 2002
Darshana Jhaveri, the youngest of the Jhaveri sisters, received the Padma Shri in 2002.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Eknath Shinde
In February 2023, after the Election Commission recognised his faction as the Shiv Sena, the party's national executive in Mumbai named Eknath Shinde its chief leader. The other three belong to Uddhav Thackeray's faction.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Maharashtra
Kishori Amonkar, of the Jaipur-Atrauli gharana, was born in Bombay (Mumbai), Maharashtra.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme
The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 guarantees every rural household that asks for unskilled manual work 100 days of wage employment a year.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Mahatma Gandhi
The Prarthana Samaj was founded in Bombay in 1867 by Atmaram Pandurang, with M. G. Ranade and R. G. Bhandarkar among its leaders; Mahatma Gandhi had no part in it.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Kanauj
The Maukharis ruled from Kanauj, which in time replaced Pataliputra as the political centre of northern India.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Molecules possessing permanent dipole
Dipole-dipole forces act between molecules with permanent dipoles, such as HCl: the partly positive end of one attracts the partly negative end of another.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Himanta Biswa Sarma
In September 2023 Singapore's Lee Kuan Yew Exchange Fellowship was conferred on Assam's Chief Minister, Himanta Biswa Sarma.

Q.19 · Answer (C) (a) - (iv); (b) - (iii); (c) - (i); (d) - (ii)
The ER serves as channels for transporting proteins, vacuoles are storage sacs, the Golgi apparatus packages materials made near the ER and dispatches them, and mitochondria generate ATP.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 1921
Kashi Vidyapith in Varanasi was founded in 1921, during the Non-Cooperation Movement, and inaugurated by Mahatma Gandhi.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Russia
The Fundamental Duties, added by the 42nd Amendment in 1976, were inspired by the Constitution of the USSR (Russia).

Q.22 · Answer (B) Four
Chhath Puja lasts four days: Nahay Khay, Kharna, the evening offering to the setting sun and the morning offering to the rising sun.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Public goods
Public goods are non-rival and non-excludable: one person's use does not reduce another's and no one can be kept from using them, as with air and national defence.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Mahatma Gandhi
Mahatma Gandhi said this in 1924: he objected not to machines as such but to labour-saving machinery that left thousands without work.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Chhattisgarh
Gaur Maria, the bison dance of the Bison Horn Maria of Bastar, belongs to Chhattisgarh.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) Brittle
Something 'brittle' is hard but breaks easily.

Q.2 · Answer (A) straight from the horse's mouth
To hear something 'straight from the horse's mouth' is to hear it from the person directly involved.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Detrimental
'Beneficial' means helpful; its opposite is 'detrimental', harmful.

Q.4 · Answer (B) wicked
'Virtuous' means morally good; its opposite is 'wicked'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Concieve
The correct spelling is 'conceive': 'e' before 'i' after 'c'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) an increase of the number
A rise is an 'increase in' something: 'an increase in the number of road accidents'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Yesterday, we were painting the door when a neighbour stopped by to say hello.
An action in progress in the past takes the past continuous, 'we were painting', and the action that interrupted it the simple past, 'stopped by'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) weather
Rain is a matter of the 'weather'; 'whether' introduces a choice.

Q.9 · Answer (C) gazing on the
SSC's key gives this segment: the usual preposition after 'gaze' is 'at', 'gazing at the crime scene'. 'Gaze on' or 'upon' is also found, mostly in literary writing, but the other three segments have no error.

Q.10 · Answer (B) enforce
Rules are 'enforced': the coaches decided to apply them more strictly.

Q.11 · Answer (B) passion
A strong love of something is 'a passion for' it: 'a passion for reading'.

Q.12 · Answer (D) far
'Far' as an adverb means 'by a great amount': 'far beyond our capacity'. 'Farther' compares distances.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Spilling the beans
To 'spill the beans' is to reveal secret information.

Q.14 · Answer (B) thunder
The correct spelling is 'thunder'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) their home than it started
'No sooner' is followed by 'than', not 'that', and the past 'started' matches 'had left': 'No sooner had they left their home than it started raining heavily.'

Q.16 · Answer (A) Shivani will go to school tomorrow for prize distribution.
The question asks for the future tense: 'Shivani will go to school tomorrow'. 'Goes' is the simple present, and 'has gone' and 'had gone' cannot refer to tomorrow.

Q.17 · Answer (B) the heaviest
Compared with every other metal, osmium needs the superlative with 'the': 'the heaviest metal'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) steak
A 'steak' is a thick slice of meat; 'stake' (a post, or a share) only sounds the same.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Moderate
'Excessive' means more than is reasonable; its opposite is 'moderate'. 'Inordinate' is a synonym.

Q.20 · Answer (A) appalling
The correct spelling is 'appalling', with a double 'p' and a double 'l'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) imagined
The Emergency changed their lives in ways they could never have 'imagined'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) sensed
Two hours into the outing they 'sensed', or felt, that something was wrong.

Q.23 · Answer (A) wrap up
The bigger shops looked ready to 'wrap up', to close for the day; many were already half-shuttered.

Q.24 · Answer (B) landmark
The court ruling and the election defeat were 'landmark' developments: events of great importance.

Q.25 · Answer (B) dampen
The Supreme Court's technical reprieve did not 'dampen', or lessen, their joy.

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